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Unchaining India

India's journey from penury to prosperity has been a roller-coaster ride. These momentous decisions steered it past troughs and upheavals and helped to create a modern, global powerhouse



Food Security

In 1952, Jawaharlal Nehru had said "everything else can wait, not agriculture". Policy shortcomings and a rising population worsened scarcity, leaving India dependent on Harry Truman's India Emergency Food Act and PL480 assistance. In 1963, Nehru told Parliament: "We cannot live on doles from other countries." As it turned out, in 1966, as India was caught in two successive years of famine, the Lyndon B. Johnson government corralled supplies and tagged India a 'ship to mouth' economy. Lal Bahadur Shastri and Indira Gandhi empowered C. Subramaniam and M.S. Swaminathan to induct hybrid seeds to ramp up yield and engineer the Green Revolution. With a harvest of 316 MT in 2022, India is among the world's top three food producers.



RACHIT GOSWAMI